

LMS MIGRATION

Project Charter & Scope

Snapshot. Move roughly 6,000 learners and years of compliance history off an aging, single-brand proprietary LMS onto a modern multi-brand SaaS platform, across three brands and multiple regions, without losing a single certification record and without pausing training.

Executive Sponsor	COO / Chief Learning Officer (owns funding and final go / no-go)
Project Manager	Kai Saks
Scope	Enterprise LMS migration, proprietary to multi-brand SaaS; ~6,000 users, 3 brands, multiple regions and languages
Duration / Budget class	~6 months (26 weeks); planning-level ROM, confirmed at vendor selection

PURPOSE & BUSINESS CASE

Why this project exists, and why now.

- **The problem:** The current LMS is a proprietary, effectively single-brand system. Reporting is manual, there is no clean way to separate content or permissions by brand or region, and no path to license or monetize training later. Every new brand, market, and language stretches it thinner.
- **The move:** A modern multi-brand SaaS platform gives HQ one governed system with brand-level and region-level content separation, role-based access, automated certification tracking, and roll-up reporting across brands, regions, and roles.
- **Strategic alignment:** Directly supports multi-brand growth and international market launches, lowers compliance and data-privacy risk across regions, frees L&D from manual admin, and opens a future revenue path through content licensing.
- **Cost of inaction:** Growing compliance exposure, rising admin hours, blocked expansion into new markets, and no monetization option. The platform becomes the ceiling on growth.

OBJECTIVES & SUCCESS CRITERIA

Every objective carries a number. Platform selection and build are scored against a weighted evaluation rubric that includes multi-language and data-residency criteria.

Objective	How we will know it worked
Move every user and compliance record with nothing lost	100% of certification and compliance records reconciled against legacy before cutover
Give learners a platform they want to use	15% or better lift in early engagement vs. legacy baseline, at 30, 60, and 90 days
Keep training running throughout	48 hours or less of planned downtime, off-peak, announced in advance
Stand up multi-brand, multi-region governance	Brand and region separation, role-based access, and roll-up reporting live at go-live
Serve every required locale	Priority content localized and live for all required languages at go-live
Stay audit-ready across regions	SOC 2 and GDPR verified (HIPAA where applicable); ADA / WCAG 2.1 AA; data residency confirmed per region
Simplify the stack	Redundant tools retired; annual savings documented for finance

HIGH-LEVEL SCOPE

Detailed deliverables and acceptance criteria live in the companion Scope of Work. At the charter level:

In scope

- Migrate ~6,000 users and groups with role-based access, plus all compliance and certification history
- Multi-brand, multi-region architecture with brand and region content separation and custom branding
- Migrate the existing library, rebuilding only the legacy or compliance-critical minimum, in SCORM/xAPI
- Localize priority content for the required languages; confirm regional data residency and governance
- SSO, HRIS/payroll, CRM, and automation integrations; cross-brand and cross-region reporting
- Change communications and admin / train-the-trainer enablement, tailored by region

Out of scope (for now)

- New content beyond the agreed rebuild set, parked in phase two
- Additional languages or markets beyond the agreed launch set
- Content monetization and eCommerce build-out, enabled by the platform and sequenced later
- Custom API builds beyond supported connectors; brand-specific customizations before standardization

KEY STAKEHOLDERS & ROLES

Stakeholder	Responsibility
Executive Sponsor	Approves funding and scope; owns final go / no-go at phase gates
Project Manager (Kai Saks)	Runs the program day to day; coordinates resources, schedule, and vendor; escalates scope and budget changes
L&D Team	Owns content rebuild, localization, and migration validation
IT / Security	Owns SSO, provisioning, data security, data residency, and integration sign-off
Legal / Compliance	Owns regional data-privacy review and Data Processing Agreements
LMS Vendor	Owns platform configuration, data migration, and SLA / support
Brand & Region Leads	Own local go-live readiness, language sign-off, and their own people

Full activity-level ownership (RACI) is maintained in the Scope of Work. Steering reviews occur at each phase gate.

HIGH-LEVEL TIMELINE & MILESTONES

A migration this size, roughly 6,000 users across three brands and several regions, is a multi-month program. I plan it in about six months by front-loading readiness and running integrations as their own workstream, the two places these projects usually break.

- **Phase 0, Readiness (Wks 1 to 4):** Stakeholder alignment, full content audit, technical and data-residency requirements, target-locale list, KPI baseline. M0: Readiness sign-off
- **Phase 1, Discovery & Selection (Wks 4 to 8):** Requirements, vendor demos on real use cases, reference checks, 3-year TCO, contract scoping. M1: Charter signed. M2: Vendor selected
- **Phase 2, Configuration (Wks 8 to 14):** Multi-brand and multi-region config, roles, learning paths, branding, reporting, compliance reports. M3: Configuration complete
- **Phase 2b, Integrations (Wks 10 to 16, parallel):** SSO/SAML, HRIS sync (separate workstream), CRM/automation, plus a 30% contingency. M4: Integrations validated

- **Phase 3, Content Migration & Localization (Wks 12 to 18):** Migrate as is where valid, rebuild the minimum, localize priority content, SCORM conformance testing. M5: Content migrated and reconciled
- **Phase 4, Testing & Pilot (Wks 18 to 22):** QA across devices and locales, pilot 20 to 50 users, iterate, 5-user go-live readiness check. M6: Pilot passed
- **Phase 5, Launch & Cutover (Wks 22 to 24):** Admin training, comms, brand-by-brand and region-by-region go-live, legacy read-only. M7: All brands live
- **Phase 6, Hypercare & Measure (Wks 24 to 26+):** Support desk, adoption tracking, 30/60/90 review against KPIs. M8: Review complete

BUDGET ESTIMATE (PLANNING-LEVEL ROM)

A rough order-of-magnitude view for authorization; exact figures are confirmed at vendor selection (M2) and detailed in the Scope of Work.

Cost area	Basis
SaaS platform licensing	Annual; scales with active users, brands, and regions
Implementation & data migration services	One-time vendor services
Content rebuild & localization	Internal L&D effort, authoring tooling, and translation
Integration & security	IT effort for SSO, HRIS/CRM connectors, and regional data-residency review
Contingency	10 to 15% of program cost
Offsets	Retired redundant tools (documented annual savings), reduced admin hours, faster onboarding ramp

RISKS & ASSUMPTIONS

Key risks & mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Data lost or mangled in the move	Migrate in waves, reconcile each before the next, keep legacy read-only as a fallback with go/no-go gates
Scope creep from brand or region requests	Charter plus change-control log; new asks route to phase two
Localization or translation delays	Lock target locales in Phase 0; use translation memory and native-speaker QA per market
Data residency or cross-border rules	Confirm regional hosting and DPAs before selection; per-region governance
SSO or HRIS sync breaks provisioning	Validate connectors in staging with real role mappings before cutover
Learners tune out from change fatigue	Early comms, quick-start guides, and a champion per brand and region; enablement tiered to digital readiness

Assumptions

- Phase 0 readiness (audit, stakeholders, target locales, KPI baseline) is complete and signed off before Phase 1 begins.
- A 30% contingency buffer applies specifically to all integration (SSO/HRIS) timelines.
- Sponsor funding is approved before Phase 1 exits; legacy stays read-only through hypercare.
- Selected vendor meets SOC 2 and GDPR (and HIPAA where health data applies), supports the required languages, and offers regional hosting where needed.
- Course content is exportable in SCORM/xAPI or reproducible in the new authoring tools.
- Brand and region leads assign a champion, sign off on language, and confirm go-live windows.
- Cutover is scheduled outside peak enrollment and major market-launch windows.

SECURITY, DATA RESIDENCY & INTEGRATIONS

Integrations: SSO (Okta); HRIS/payroll (ADP, Gusto, Paycom); ops/CRM (ClubReady, Salesforce); automation (Zapier, Monday.com); content (SCORM/xAPI, LRS).

Security & regions: SOC 2 and GDPR (HIPAA where applicable), regional data residency and hosting where required, encryption in transit and at rest, role-based access, IP protection, and per-region Data Processing Agreements. Rollback: legacy read-only with wave-by-wave reconciliation gates.

GOVERNANCE & SIGN-OFF

Scope changes are handled by change request to the Executive Sponsor. This charter authorizes the project and the Project Manager's use of resources upon signature.

Executive Sponsor _____	Date _____
Project Manager, Kai Saks _____	Date _____